Qiheng Lin

林琦桁

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Research Interests and Methods

Human–AI relations; digital intimacy; influencer industries; gender and digital labor.

Methods: ethnography, fieldwork, in-depth interviews, and social network analysis (UCINET and ENA).

Education

Renmin University of China Sep 2025–present

Ph.D. in Journalism and Communication, expected June 2029.

Renmin University of China Sep 2023–Jun 2025

Master of Journalism and Communication. GPA: 3.93/4.00; ranked 1st overall in the program.

Wuhan University Sep 2019–Jun 2023

Bachelor's degree in Radio and Television. GPA: 3.88/4.00; ranked 1st in the program for four consecutive years.

Journal Articles

Lin, Q., & Dong, C. (2026). The managed sisterhood: Gendered labor and intimacy in Chinese fashion influencer industry. *New Media & Society*. OnlineFirst, October 22, 2026. https://doi.org/10.1177/14614448261493399

Lin, Q., & Peng, L. (2026). From viewing to co-presence: The turn toward companionship in online audiovisual media and its challenges. [从观看到共处：网络视听媒介的"伴生"转向及其挑战] *China Television* [中国电视] (CSSCI), (3), 14–22.

Dong, C., **Lin, Q.**, & Liu, L. (2026). Wanghong: Understanding a local Chinese concept. [网红：理解一个中国本土概念] *News and Writing* [新闻与写作] (CSSCI), (6), 5–15.

Ding, Y., Dong, C., Lü, X., **Lin, Q.**, Chen, Z., & Xu, Y. (2026). An annual review of Western communication research in 2025. [2025 年西方传播学研究年度报告] *Journalism Review* [新闻记者] (CSSCI), (1), 50–71.

Dong, C., **Lin, Q.**, & Liu, L. (2025). When technology meets love: Algorithms, interfaces, and the rise of unconventional intimacy. [当技术遇到爱：算法、界面与非常态亲密关系的崛起] *News and Writing* [新闻与写作] (CSSCI), (11), 5–13.

Dong, C., & **Lin, Q.** (2024). "Adhesive" and "metronome": Thematic evolution of online public opinion through a multidimensional social network analysis of the Li Jiaqi controversy. ["黏连剂"与"节拍器"：网络舆论议题的主题演化——对李佳琦"怒怼网友"事件的多维社会网络分析] *Media Observer* [传媒观察] (CSSCI), (6), 24–34.

Dong, C., Xu, Y., & **Lin, Q.** (2024). Social interaction on platforms: Three strands of research on interpersonal communication on social media. [交往在平台：社交媒体人际传播研究的三条线索] *News and Writing* [新闻与写作] (CSSCI), (9), 5–14. Reprinted in full in Xinhua Digest.

Dong, C., Xu, Y., Ding, Y., Yu, W., **Lin, Q.**, Chen, Q., & Wang, H. (2024). An annual review of Western communication research in 2023. [2023 年西方传播学研究年度报告] *Journalism Review* [新闻记者] (CSSCI), (1), 81–101, 41.

Lin, Q. (2022). Innovating empathic communication in mainstream media short videos: A case study of Xiaoyang Video. [主流媒体短视频共情传播的创新路径研究——以小央视频为例] *View on Publishing* [出版广角] (CSSCI Expanded), (6), 93–96.

Ji, L., & **Lin, Q.** (2022). Communication strategies for mainstream media short videos from a technology empowerment perspective. [技术赋能视角下主流媒体短视频传播路径研究] *China Radio* [中国广播], (3), 9–14.

Book Reviews and Yearbook Contributions

Dong, C., Liu, L., & **Lin, Q.** (2025). From content creators to entrepreneurs: What does "wanghong" really mean? A review of The Influencer Factory. [从内容生产者到企业家："网红"究竟意味着什么?——评《网红工厂：一种 YouTube 企业化人格的马克思主义理论》] *China Book Review* [中国图书评论], (12), 20–29.

Lin, Q., & Dong, C. (2025). A review of research on Chinese influencers and livestreamers, 2023–2024. [中国网红主播研究 2023—2024 综述] *Yearbook of Journalism and Communication of China* [中国新闻传播学年鉴], Editorial Office of Journalism & Communication [新闻与传播研究编辑部].

Translation Projects

The Craft of Research, 5th edition (2025–2026). Lead translator of the Chinese edition. Xinhua Publishing House. In proofreading; not yet published.

In the Meantime: Temporality and Cultural Politics (2024–2025). Sole translator of the complete initial Chinese manuscript. China Renmin University Press. In proofreading; not yet published.

Conference Presentations

Lin, Q. (Jun 2025). Digital Healing Arts: Imaginaries and Practice of "AI Resurrection" under Chinese Views on Life and Death. 75th Annual International Communication Association Conference (ICA). Oral presentation · Denver, USA.

Lin, Q. (Jul 2025). In the Name of "Sisters": Managed Sisterhoods as Gendered Labor in Chinese Fashion Influencer Industry. International Association for Media and Communication Research Conference (IAMCR). Oral presentation · Singapore.

Lin, Q., & Zhao, R. (Aug 2025). Curating the Real-time: Classification Labor in Chinese E-commerce Live-streaming. American Sociological Association Annual Meeting (ASA). Oral presentation · Chicago, USA.

Lin, Q. (Oct 2026). From an Object of Remembrance to a Relational Other: The Workings and Limits of AI Resurrection within a Media Ensemble of Life and Death. [从纪念对象到关系对象：生死媒介丛中 AI 复生的运作与边界] Communication and China | Fudan Forum (2026). Presentation · Fudan University, Shanghai, China.

Dong, C., & **Lin, Q.** (Nov 2024). Manufacturing authenticity: Influencers' authenticity labor and its precarity. [制造本真：网红的本真性劳动及其不稳定性] 17th Chinese Young Communication Scholars Forum. Oral presentation · Shanghai, China.

Lin, Q. (Apr 2024). Understanding wanghong: An academic framework for a popular concept. [理解“网红”：一个流行概念的学术框架] Fifth Qingmei Forum. Poster presentation · Guangzhou, China.

Honors and Awards

2021 National Scholarship (Undergraduate)

2024 National Scholarship (Master’s)

2026 Doctoral Academic Scholarship; Ranked 1st in the doctoral cohort

2026 Doctoral Special-Class Scholarship for Academic Excellence; Ranked 1st in the doctoral cohort

2024 First-Class Academic Scholarship, Renmin University of China

2022 Yu Gang–Song Xiao Scholarship; Top 1%

2020–2022 First-Class Scholarship, Wuhan University

2020 Blue Moon Scholarship

2025 Beijing Outstanding Graduate

2023 Outstanding Graduate, Wuhan University

2023 Grand Prize, Beijing Graduate English Speech Contest

2023 Model Merit Student, Wuhan University; Top 1%

2024 Merit Student, Renmin University of China

2020–2023 Merit Student, Wuhan University; Awarded in each of four consecutive years

2025 Outstanding Youth League Member, Renmin University of China

2020–2022 Social Activities Award, Wuhan University

Other Academic Experience

Fudan University Graduate Summer School Aug 2024

New Media and Just Communication in the Global Information Society. Delivered the closing remarks as the sole master’s student representative.

Undergraduate Research Project Lead 2022

A study of the communication effects of neo-frugality advertising among university students. University-level project; completed.

China–Russia Youth Leadership Summer Camp 5–14 Jul 2026

Student assistant, Renmin University of China, Beijing. Supported organization and coordination throughout the programme, including academic sessions, media visits, cultural exchange, and collaborative video production.

Industry Experience

2024 **ShowWorld** — E-commerce livestreaming coordination (internship).

2023 **ByteDance · TikTok cross-border business** — Advertising operations (internship).

2022 **ByteDance · Feishu PR & Marketing** — Social media operations (internship).

2022 **Xinhua News Agency · New Media Department** — Editor, Ask a Reporter (internship).

2021 **China Unicom · Wuhan** — New media design and operations (internship).

2021 **Tencent · Television drama** — Content operations (internship).